INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Economics

HOSPITALITY & TOURISM
TEAM DECISION MAKING EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain how organizations adapt to today's markets.
2. Distinguish between economic goods and services.
3. Determine economic utilities created by business activities.
4. Explain factors that motivate people to choose a hospitality and tourism site.
5. Explain the nature of overhead/operating costs.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the roles of the director of guest experience and the director of operations for PINECREST LAKE RESORT, a 140-room lakeside resort about three hours from two major cities. The owner (judge) wants your team to recommend how PINECREST should adapt to guests who are spending less on travel.

PINECREST offers rooms and cabins, two restaurants, a spa, a marina with boat rentals and a gift shop that sells local goods. Most guests drive in for long weekends. Room rates range from $249 to $429 per night, and guests have historically spent another $180 per day on dining, spa services and activities.

Travel habits are changing. With prices up and household budgets tight, PINECREST's bookings for next summer are 14% behind last year. Guests who do book are staying shorter and spending 25% less on extras. Many say they are choosing campgrounds, short-term rentals and day trips instead. Meanwhile, PINECREST's operating costs keep rising. Utility, insurance and labor costs are up 11%, and the resort's restaurants and spa are open seven days a week even when only half the rooms are filled.

The owner (judge) wants a plan before summer rates are published in eight weeks. Specifically, the owner (judge) wants your team to:

- Explain why travelers are cutting back and what still motivates them to choose a resort
- Identify the goods and services PINECREST sells and which ones create the most value for guests
- Recommend changes to PINECREST's offerings or packages to attract budget-minded guests without cheapening the brand
- Explain how PINECREST can manage its operating costs during slower periods

You will present your recommendations to the owner (judge) in a meeting to take place in the owner's (judge's) office. The owner (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your recommendations and have answered the owner's (judge's) questions, the owner (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. What is the difference between the goods and the services we sell, and why does it matter for pricing?
2. If we lower prices or add discount packages, how do we keep guests who are willing to pay full price?

Rate the participants' ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain how organizations adapt to today's markets.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Distinguish between economic goods and services.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Determine economic utilities created by business activities.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Explain factors that motivate people to choose a hospitality and tourism site.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Explain the nature of overhead/operating costs.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
9.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
12.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	